

THE DAILY BRIEF

Monday, June 15, 2026

Markets & Finance

MAJOR MARKET MOVES AND FINANCIAL NEWS

Elon Musk Crossed \$1 Trillion on Friday, Becoming the World's First Trillionaire. SpaceX's IPO closed up 19% above its \$135 offering price, making Elon Musk the first human being in history to reach a net worth of \$1 trillion. The shares have continued trading above the IPO price through the weekend, cementing a milestone that Forbes once called "a number that used to be reserved for nation-states." SpaceX raised \$75 billion in the offering, making it not just the biggest IPO of the year but arguably the biggest in American history. (TechCrunch, FT)

Wall Street's Biggest Test: Absorbing the AI Issuance Flood. SpaceX was only the opening act. SpaceX, Anthropic, and Alphabet all closed or advanced major financings in the same two-week window, testing whether institutional and retail investors have the appetite — and the capital — to absorb a torrent of new issuance from companies that are simultaneously the most exciting and the most unprofitable on planet earth. The fact that SpaceX cleared with a 19% first-day pop suggests the answer is yes, at least for now. (FT)

Oil Touches a Three-Month Low After Trump Signals US Is Close to an Iran Deal. Crude fell sharply on Friday after the President said an agreement with Iran was imminent, raising hopes that a surge in oil supply could ease the energy inflation that has been pinching consumers and industrial margins alike. If the deal holds, it would be the most significant diplomatic development in the Gulf since the 2015 JCPOA — and one that could keep inflation readings lower through the second half of the year. (FT)

Sam Bankman-Fried's Fraud Conviction Upheld on Appeal. The former FTX founder lost his bid to overturn his 25-year prison sentence when a three-judge panel upheld the original verdict. The decision closes the book on one of crypto's most spectacular collapses — and sends a clear signal to the remaining figures in the industry that regulatory patience for spectacular crypto blow-ups has a firm floor. (FT)

Robinhood Saw Record-Breaking Sign-Ups After SpaceX Trading Began. The trading platform reported its highest-ever single-day new account creations as retail investors piled in to get a piece of the most anticipated listing since Meta's 2012 Facebook debut. Some customers experienced brief outages

during the peak frenzy, a familiar pattern whenever a culturally iconic stock hits the market.
(TechCrunch)

AI & Tech

LATEST IN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, MODELS, AND TECHNOLOGY

Anthropic's Most Powerful AI Was Pulled From the Market by the Government — And the Company Is Furious. In one of the more remarkable episodes in the short, dramatic history of AI regulation, the US government ordered Anthropic to halt access to two of its most capable models on Friday, citing a "narrow potential jailbreak" that the company's own safety team had flagged proactively. Anthropic pushed back hard in a blog post, writing: "We disagree that the finding of a narrow potential jailbreak should be cause for recalling a commercial model deployed to hundreds of millions of people." The dispute crystallizes the fundamental tension between AI companies that want to ship fast and a government that is increasingly unwilling to let them. (TechCrunch)

Amazon CEO Andy Jassy Reportedly Flagged the Anthropic Security Concerns Before the Crackdown. The Amazon CEO — whose company has invested up to \$8 billion in Anthropic — may have been the internal source that triggered the government's decision to restrict access to the models. The revelation raises uncomfortable questions about the role of a major investor in flagging concerns about a company it has a financial stake in. (TechCrunch)

OpenAI Is Under Investigation From State Attorneys General. Multiple state attorneys general have opened inquiries into OpenAI's practices, with questions ranging from how the company handles health data to its advertising policies. The investigation adds to the growing list of regulatory headwinds facing Sam Altman and his company as it races toward a commercial future while navigating an increasingly complex legal landscape. (TechCrunch)

India Is Debating Its Entire AI Strategy After the Anthropic Episode. As Anthropic suspended access to new model downloads globally — including in India — tech leaders in Bangalore and New Delhi are using the moment to push for a sovereign AI infrastructure that doesn't depend on the goodwill of American companies or the fickle attentions of Washington regulators. The episode has exposed just how dependent the world's most populous nation is on AI capabilities it does not control. (TechCrunch)

Meta Is Dismantling Its \$2 Billion Acquisition of Manus AI After Beijing Ordered the Deal Reversed. In a rare instance of Chinese regulators reversing a completed tech acquisition, Meta has begun unwinding its purchase of Manus, the Chinese AI startup it acquired in a deal that raised eyebrows from the moment it was announced. The reversal is a reminder that in the US-China tech cold war, cross-border AI acquisitions are essentially dead. (TechCrunch)

KPMG Pulled an Entire Research Report Because It Appeared to Be Full of AI Hallucinations. The accounting giant retracted a published study on AI adoption after readers noticed that the report cited sources, statistics, and even company names that did not appear to exist. The episode is a embarrassment wrapped in irony — an AI company producing unreliable information about AI — but it also points to a broader problem as consulting firms race to publish AI research that often relies on

AI-generated inputs. (TechCrunch)

Mistral, Europe's Flagship AI Company, Is Reportedly Raising €3 Billion at a €20 Billion Valuation. The French AI startup, which has staked out a reputation as Europe's best hope for a homegrown alternative to American AI giants, is in advanced talks for a massive new funding round that would nearly double its previous valuation of €11.7 billion. If confirmed, it would be one of the largest private AI financings in Europe's history. (TechCrunch)

Briefly

- › Section 702 Surveillance Law Expires for First Time: The NSA and FBI's warrantless surveillance authority expired Friday after lawmakers rejected Trump's nominee to lead US intelligence agencies. It marks the first time the controversial provision has lapsed since it was enacted. (TechCrunch)
 - › Paramount's \$111 Billion Warner Bros Takeover Wins Antitrust Approval: David Ellison's audacious media merger cleared its last major regulatory hurdle, setting up the creation of a new entertainment powerhouse in an industry still grappling with streaming economics. (FT)
 - › China Is Building a Dollar-Competing Payments System: Beijing is rolling out a cross-border digital payments platform backed by the central banks of Hong Kong, Thailand, the UAE, and Saudi Arabia — the most concrete step yet toward a post-dollar infrastructure for international trade. (FT)
 - › Apollo Picks Austin for Its Second Headquarters: The private capital giant chose Austin over Miami and Palm Beach, citing Florida's capacity constraints on private schools — a quiet signal that the flow of capital to Florida may be finding its natural ceiling. (FT)
-

The Takeaway

The defining story this Sunday morning is still Musk's trillion-dollar milestone — but the real story underneath is the collision between AI ambition and government authority. The Anthropic shutdown is the most vivid illustration yet that the era of AI companies operating as fast as they want and facing only market consequences is ending. Jassy flagging concerns about a company Amazon has \$8 billion invested in, state attorneys general circling OpenAI, and Beijing reversing a Meta acquisition in real time — these are not isolated incidents. They are the early architecture of an AI governance regime that will define how these companies can operate for the next decade. The markets are celebrating SpaceX. The regulators are already past it.
